

CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

◀ SAYANI GHOSH, *31*

| TMC | *Jadavpur, West Bengal*

Among her films, you find the anthemic title *Ekla Chalo*—reprising Tagore's stirring fiat to the broken and the deserted to strike out alone. But that 2015 release was no essay in solitary splendour: it co-starred fellow debutant MP June Maliah. Today, the Trinamool benches in the Lok Sabha—in the vicinity of the fire-breathing Mahua Moitra—again stars Sayani in that smouldering platoon, watching, listening, smiling at the witticisms, rebutting the foolhardy interjecter, thoroughly engaged. Jadavpur, which gave Sayani her debut win in a three-year political career, would approve. It has a reputation to keep—and she's aware of it. "I wish to keep an 80 per cent attendance in Parliament and ask researched, relevant questions," she told INDIA TODAY.



▲ PARTHA BHOWMICK, *60*

| TMC | *Barrackpur, West Bengal*

Amateur theatre was his stage for years, before thespian Bratya Basu blooded him in the professional circuit in 2010. That was a time when West Bengal politics was about to turn an epoch. He too graduated to Trinamool politics along with his mentor, becoming an MLA in 2011 and a state minister in 2022. His prolific acting career continued, including with 2023 web series *Abar Proloy*. The deluge now moves to Parliament Street.

YUSUF PATHAN, *41* ▶

| TMC | *Baharampur, West Bengal*

In a time of innocence, with no reference to spatial context, if someone had opened bets on which of the two Pathan brothers was a likely candidate for politics, most punters may have picked the younger Irfan. Always smiling, more personable, as much of a natural before the camera as he was with the swinging ball, readymade material for a public life. The elder Yusuf, by contrast, seemed to be built of stern granite—one who preferred inarticulacy till it came to the point where the ball had to be cannoned out of the ground. But Baharampur was not a place you could win with light conversation. For a quarter-century, it had been the lair of Congress strongman Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury, the man who thought nothing of taking on Mamata Banerjee herself. If such a Goliath had to be felled, the David needed to be military grade. Yusuf, who admitted to having no clue where Baharampur was when he became Mamata's surprise pick, mined his past association with Kolkata Knight Riders to dilute the outsider tag—and heaved Adhir over long on.



Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

-Anilesh S. Mahajan, Jeemon Jacob, Prashant Srivastava and Arkamoy Datta Majumdar